

Every company is going to want its own harness for AI. Port42 is that harness.

EVERYONE BOUGHT THE HORSE. NOBODY HAS THE COLLAR.

For most of recorded history people had horses and couldn't use them for work. The old throat-and-girth harness ran across the animal's windpipe: the harder it pulled, the more it choked itself. So horses carried messages and nobles, while oxen (slower, dumber, strong in the wrong ways) pulled the ploughs. Then the horse collar arrived in Europe around the 10th century. It moved the load onto the shoulders. The same animal, unchanged, could suddenly pull a plough through heavy soil all day. Within a few generations European agriculture had reorganized around it.

The horse was never the bottleneck. The harness was.

Every company now has the horse. Frontier models are extraordinary, they get better every quarter, and they are available to your competitors at the same price on the same afternoon. **The model is not where the advantage is, and everyone has quietly worked this out.** What no company has is the harness: the thing that connects that power to the actual work, in their actual context, under their actual control.

You can see the gap from your desk. It's the copy and paste. Out of the agent, into the work, back out again, a hundred times a day. Every one of those is a place the agent should have had hands and didn't. **The human is the integration layer.** That isn't a workflow. It's a missing harness with a person standing in for it.

EVERYONE IS BUILDING A HARNESS. THEIRS.

The vendors know the harness is the prize. Claude Desktop, Codex, Cursor: they have surfaces, they keep context, they are racing to be the place your work happens. Nobody needs persuading that the harness matters. That argument is over, and it's the strongest confirmation this thesis has.

It's also the problem. Their harness is built to hold their model, and to hold you. Your work lives inside their experience, on their terms, moving at their roadmap. You are a tenant.

And it only works if everyone brings the same horse. A vendor's harness assumes your whole team standardized on one model, permanently, while the frontier moves every quarter and your best engineer wants a different tool by Thursday. **A harness that only fits one horse isn't a harness. It's a saddle for one animal.**

SO EVERY COMPANY BUILDS ITS OWN

The harness is not a feature of the model. It's the shape of *your* work: your surfaces, your rules, your people, your data, the memory of what happened here last week. That is exactly the part a model vendor cannot ship you, because it isn't theirs to know. And it's exactly the part you cannot afford to rent.

A hospital's harness is not a law firm's harness is not a trading desk's. The horizontal case, developers, is the same shape with different surfaces.

Today they build it from scratch, badly, out of glue: a chat wrapper, a pile of API keys, a permissions story invented in a meeting, and no shared surface anywhere. Port42 is that harness, as a platform, so the company builds *their* harness instead of the plumbing under it. Your keys. Anthropic, Gemini, any OpenAI-compatible endpoint, a local model. CLI agents like Claude Code sit in the room as first-class members. **The harness is yours; the horse stays a choice you keep making.**

GO TO MARKET: ENGINEERING TEAMS FIRST

Your agent already lives in a terminal. Give it a room.

Engineering teams are the only market that has already crossed the gap. They don't need convincing that an agent can do the work; they watched it happen this morning. They feel the harness problem daily without a word for it: the agent runs in a pane, alone, reporting text about work nobody else can see. And they buy bottom-up. One person installs a DMG, with no procurement between them and the first run.

They are also how every other vertical gets reached. The hospital's harness will be built by the hospital's engineers. The horizontal isn't a detour from the verticals; it's the channel into them.

WHAT THE HARNESS ACTUALLY IS



A SPACE	is a room. People and AI companions are both <i>in</i> it. It persists: memory, a history, a working directory on real disk. The AI has a place, and the place remembers.
A PORT	is a live surface both of you drive. Not the agent sending a report about the chart, or opening it in a browser. You and the agent <i>in</i> the chart, same surface, same moment. Web or terminal.
ONE BRIDGE	two callers. A human reaches the clipboard, screen, files, terminal through the UI. An agent reaches the same methods as tools. One implementation. That symmetry is the whole design, and it's already how the product works.
PERMISSION	is the leash. Every capability gated per category, per asker, revocable. The harness transmits power <i>and</i> makes it safe to apply. The part the glue-code version never has, and the reason those pilots quietly never ship.

CHAT ALREADY PROVES IT. YOU JUST HAVEN'T NOTICED.

Nobody screen-shares a chat window. You sync the messages, and each end renders its own chat, natively. It would be absurd to stream pixels of a conversation across the internet.

That's the model for *every* surface. Chat just got there first, because messages were always data. Port42's bet is that a port is the same kind of object: you send it queries and it emits a stream, so it can be driven by a human, or an agent, or a peer on another machine, through one contract. Streaming pixels is what you do to surfaces you don't own. It's the fax machine of collaboration: it works, and it throws away everything that made the thing a thing.

A port describes itself completely, so it moves. Send one to another instance (different machine, different database) and it arrives running. There is nothing to export. What doesn't travel yet are the *addresses* it refers to: **the copy is free; the addressing is the remaining work.**

WHAT'S REAL TODAY

Port42 ships as a Mac app. The desktop *is* live ports: the conventional windowed mode was deleted in July, not deprecated. Spaces, companions (both API models and CLI agents like Claude Code), the unified bridge across ~40 capability methods, local-first storage, end-to-end encrypted sync between instances, and full version history for every port. **It is used daily to build itself.**

THE MOTION

- LAND One developer, one machine, no account. Local-first, offline, your keys. First run reaches "*my agent is in a room and it just made me something I can touch.*" That ships today.
- EXPAND A team space: two humans and their agents, encrypted, synced.
- PROVE The first company building its harness inside Port42 is Port42. Every surface exists because the work demanded it, and every failure lands on me first. Doing that in public is how the proof travels: engineering teams don't believe demos, they believe a bug hunt.